BRIGHAM YOUNG
UNIVERSITY
IDAHO

ED 211: Teaching as a Profession

- **Class times: T/Th 10:15-11:15 HIN 307.**
- **Office hours: T/Th 2:30-3:30 HIN 249.***
- **Lab hours: F 4-6 PM. HIN 307.**

Part I: Course Introduction

Instructor: Benjamin Pacini **(**But, like, call me BroPa). pacinib@byui.edu**. 801.618.7865.**** Zoom: 899.634.5818.

Me: *Steps up to lectern. Clears throat.*

Y'all we're about to have so much fun. We do crazy projects, redesign education, watch hilarious cat videos, and do penguin hunts. Tons of work, but tons of fun. Also memes. And sucrose. (Candy.) AND PENGUINS HOW COULD I FORGET PENGUINS! (You should see how many penguins you find. Seriously. Count them. Good luck.)

Are you afraid of technology? Are you not sure what the internet is? Not yet sure what it means to rick-roll someone*****? Well have I GOT THE CLASS FOR YOU!

This class is about helping you figure out technology to use in your classroom, but also to ask questions that you've never asked before: what is school really for? How can we make education better? How can I be a life-changing teacher? You'll also learn what technology has to do with helping your students succeed (hint: everything). All this, and a dash of restored gospel: because we aren't just here to be good teachers, we're here to be "a place of educational innovation perpetually." We'll talk about what BYU-Idaho offers that is unique, and how it can help you, your future students, and the world. And it can–not only help, but change the world.

A story: when I was a boy, I learned about a little white stone. It was an incredible idea: you could look at the stone and learn anything you wanted to. I was entranced. Look up D&C 130, and let it change your life. What could we do if we understood what God has in store for us? What technologies is He waiting to inspire? What will He inspire you to do?

FOR THE ADMINISTRATORS READING: This class will be a survey of prominent educational technology applications as aligned to Idaho State Code and the ISTE standards with a culminating assessment of a portfolio of sundry educational technology projects. Penguin. Students will be required to make projects, read readings, align standards, do educational objectives, spell things, not put pencils up their nose, etc. Formative assessments will include portfolio, educational technology projects, and formative assessments. Bloom's taxonomy. Buzzwords. Educational objectives. Rigor. Coursework will be authentic and simulative and summative and serendipitous and penguins. More rigor.

Anyway, the goal is *not* simply to have you master EdTech--it's to learn how to master tech tools in general, because the things we learn will be obsolete soon. Your job is to *learn how to learn.* Really, the goal is to help you *create* something that will change lives. Also, I don't apologize for being an overly-excited, happily intense, moderately insane personal trainer. Feel the burn--and love it! We work hard, but it'll change the way you see everything in life.

Welcome to Ed 211. Buckle up. We're going to have fun. So excited to have you!

Brother Benjamin Pacini (BroPa)

*Seriously, just come by. I'm off campus Mon/Wed/Fri, but other times I'm easy to find. I'll bring the memes, candy, and dad jokes. You bring… you. I guess. Or don't.
**I'm a terrible texter. I'm mediocre at answering phones, but I'm decent w/email. Best of all is the zoom channel, which I'll show in class.
***This is your first penguin. PENGUIN! (Still only counts as one.)
**** Google voice is great because it has a great spam screen to keep out detestable vacuum salespeople. Say who you are, and it'll put you through.
***** See here. The RickRoll is the highest form of humor. Fight me.

Part II: Course Breakdown and Grading:

Course Breakdown:

- **Major projects**: We learn by doing: the juicy part of this class, where you do the most learning, is in the weekly projects. These projects can always be submitted early, and can be resubmitted as many times as needed to earn a high grade--if the project is submitted before the deadline. These projects will all be put into one place (Portfolium) so that future employers can see your excellent work, and that of your projects. Remember: the goal is to learn how to learn, not just to learn how to use 13 EdTech apps.
- **Readings**: I have carefully curated a set of readings that are a total joy. I genuinely think you will love them. They are an eclectic blend of readings from practical to silly to inspiring and joyful. Students will participate in reading activities, including oral exams, fishbowls, etc. The purpose is both accountability and to foster rich discussion. Penguin. Please note that not being prepared for class is a minor grading issue. Pretending to be prepared when one is not is an integrity issue. Students will have the chance to opt out of one reading per semester with no consequence, called "a mulligan" so long as they communicate this before the class begins.
    - Reading Checks: As you complete the readings, you should take notes on what you learn. You will then upload your notes and write a brief reflection on what you learned and what you hope to remember. You will also assign yourself a score which will be checked and verified by the TA. Grade yourself honestly, and if you have to choose, err on the side of being harsh. We really like to change grades upward rather than downward!
    - Reading Expectations: You should spend an average of roughly 90 minutes per reading, including note-taking. If you get to 120 minutes (two hours) you should stop and reach out to me. You should read for conversion, not for coverage; the purpose of this reading is to change the way you see the world, not to memorize facts or information. At the same time, if you haven't completed the reading in two hours, you should reach out to me. Learn to read quickly and slowly–both matter.
- **Contribution to Community**: One of the most important parts of this class (to me) is modeling for you how important a strong community is. This includes attendance, but also positive contribution to class, such as submitting memes to the thread, capturing great quotes, or providing a bit of daily inspiration. You will be asked to do fun, silly, joyful things just for the sake of making connections.
    - Attendance checks: Students will upload their notes, grade their own participation, and write a brief reflection of how they participated in class for each week of class. Each attendance check contains two days of attendance.
    - Teaches: We become great teachers by teaching. You will be required to teach regularly in my class for credit. Grading is based on preparedness and the extent to which students engage their peers. Students will teach at least three times, and will be graded by the professor, TA, and peers.
    - Participation Self-Check and Peer Reviews: Students will have the chance to submit a participation self-check and a peer review for members of their group at the end of the semester.
    - Surveys and Ratings: I am always hungry for feedback about my courses. You will be asked to give some feedback to me at midterm and end-of-semester.
- **Technology proficiency exam**: It is required for graduation that you succeed in passing the Google Teacher Certification (Level I) assessment, and so I have made it worth a grade in this class to attempt the exam, independent of whether you pass or not. It is 5% of your grade, and so should encourage you to get it done. You should be able to get it done fully independently, but I will offer reminders during class. The best preparation for

the exam is to take the exam. It is $10, and it is new enough that much of the prep material is outdated and references the old exam.

Attendance Note:
Attendance is necessary--but not sufficient for--success in this class. Students can miss two days of class with no penalty. After that, each day of missed class that is unexcused is a drop of a full letter grade. If a student works with me, I can excuse up to an additional four days total. Any students who misses more than six days–even in extenuating circumstances–will be required to repeat the class. Don't just participate, bring light and joy to the class.

Questions and Communication
In the first week of class, you will learn about our zoom channel: please check it daily. (You can check on any non-chromebook computer, or any smartphone.) While I'm always happy to answer questions, please do all you can to ask peers and consult class materials (e.g. syllabus) before reaching out. Questions that may apply to the whole class can be asked in the Zoom chat; personal questions should be emailed. I encourage people to ask their group first, the zoom channel second, the TA third, and BroPa fourth--to build your capacity to answer your own questions. That said, just ask! I love interacting with students, and will happily answer even if you go out of order.

The next line contains invisible text. Highlight with your cursor to see what it says.

Grading:
Please reference the University's grading explanation here. Letter Grades are assigned according to the following scale:

A	93-100	A-	90-93	B+	87-89	B	83-86
B-	80-82	C+	77-79	C	73-76	C-	70-73
D+	67-69	D	63-66	D-	60-62	F	0-59

Grade Breakdown:

5%	Technology Competency Exam
15%	Reading Checks
15%	Contribution to Community (Participation and Attendance Checks)
20%	Weekly Teaches
40%	Major Projects (Portfolium)

Required Texts:
- The Google Infused Classroom
- The Innovator's Mindset

Part III: Course Expectations and Explanations:

Required Course Materials:

- You will need a functioning laptop. It is your job to make sure it works. (Not joking.)
- You will need a quality pair of headphones. (Quality doesn't mean expensive.)
- Bring a nameplate (Or make one using white card stock and black marker. Write large and clear.)
- You will need a dry erase marker, a sheet protector, and something to use to erase with (old sock is fine).
- You will need access to your BYUI email and the course zoom channel.

Paying for EdTech:
The only thing you will have to pay for in this class is the Google Teacher Certification Exam Level 1. It costs $10. Otherwise, you will never be required to pay for apps, but if you have already purchased them you are welcome to use them. As a teacher, it's important to find a way to spend as little as possible to get the job done. Reach out if you can't

access a technology. The only payment will potentially be for a tech exam, which will be explained in class. (Do not sign up for something costly. If you do, you will be required to pay the full cost.)

Course Policies and Procedures:

Statement on dress code and honor code:
I have worked in schools that have no honor code, and it makes me pretty grateful to be here. I'm a pretty big fan. I hope you are too. Do I care about little tiny rules? Not really, no. But I care a great deal about integrity–yes, even in the little things.

And while I'm only a little evil, I am evil. I am a former middle school teacher, and assistant principal. Be wise. Be kind to yourself, and keep the rules without being asked. Be kind to me by not making me have an awkward conversation. My background is such that I will say something. Keep your promises. If you have an issue with anything, bring it up *before* you break it. I'm pretty easy to talk to about these things. Keep in mind that the honor code is a lot more than just dress and grooming–so let's do both. We'll discuss this more in class.

On Tuesdays, you're encouraged to dress up a little for devotional. I think you'd be surprised to see what a difference it can make. Also, come looking fancy on days when you are teaching. Remember "dress down" days? "Dress up" instead.

Mastery-Based Learning and Late Work
This class functions in the paradigm of Mastery-based learning, originally conceived of by Benjamin Bloom. It's good stuff, and you should look it up. (Here's a thing I wrote on it if you need a life.) What this means for you is that you may keep submitting work to get the grade you desire so long as you meet the following two criteria:

1) You submit the work early (or on time)
2) You submit work that is clearly your best effort.

Late work will not be penalized, but will only be graded once. Typically it will be graded by me rather than the TAs (and I tend to be a little harsher than they are). You will not have a chance to resubmit for improved grades if you submit late. All assignments can be submitted late with no penalty, with the exception of missing too much class to pass the course.

Zeroes
Mastery-based learning is great because it allows you to resubmit: that means that you can keep working at it until you understand the assignment. It also allows me to set a high bar for coursework. As such, most work in my class is graded pass/fail: you either get an A or a 0. If you have a 0 in your gradebook, you should interpret it as "an assignment I haven't quite got down yet." You will get more zeroes than you are used to. Don't stress. Keep at it. Take the feedback and resubmit. Talk to me if you need.

Peer Grading
You will do a lot of peer grading and peer feedback. You are about to be teachers, so this is good training. I expect you to grade with **kindness, honesty, and care**. While you will give suggested grades, I am ultimately responsible for grades in this course.

Teaches cannot be made up outside of meeting with me. If you know you will miss a teach, try to swap with another teammate early. If you wake up sick, contact me to find a way to make up the teach. Please be mature and professional about extenuating circumstances. (*cough* family-vacations-aren't-emergencies *cough*) You will find me to be very understanding, if you are very responsible.

Submitting Links
This is an educational technology class. Do not share links that aren't properly shared, or your picture will be put on the wall of shame.

Note on Emotional Health
I believe strongly that creating emotionally strong, resilient students is about both decreasing stress, and increasing capacity. If discussions of emotional health are sensitive or difficult for you, please let me know as early as possible. I do not claim to have all the right ideas on this, but feel it to be important enough to bring up and discuss.

Additionally, I suspect that many of you lean toward perfectionism: teaching will help with that. You will learn, quickly, the art of "good enough." You should never feel the need to spend 3 hours on a 1 hour assignment. Be wise. Learn how to manage your own time carefully. Learn that excellence is better than perfectionism (including in grades) and know the difference between integrity and scrupulosity.

A thought on emotional health and grades: I hope all of you are aiming for an A. But I hope you realize that the real goal isn't the A, it's the learning--it's the success that you'll have in your classroom someday because of what you learned, the students' lives who will be changed, and the relationships you'll build with teachers, parents, students, and communities--and most importantly, the Lord. This is a very long-term game. You will see your success measured not in months, or even years, but decades and generations.

Sensitive Topics
The world is in tremendous turmoil. The devil is stirring men's hearts up unto anger, and it's hard to even have conversations on some topics. Elder Paul V. Johnson has asked faculty to have both "moral courage" and "intellectual courage." I do not believe that it is in your best interest for me to avoid difficult conversations. To the contrary, learning how to wrestle with difficult topics is one of the most important things you can take from your BYU-Idaho education. As such, I will attempt to do so with openness, sensitivity, and honesty. If there are questions that are important to you, don't hesitate to ask me privately--and if appropriate, I may raise such issues in class, as well. I should also be clear that everything these days is politicized, and everyone is angry. The solution is not to disagree less, but to disagree better. I do not expect you to agree with everything I say--I only expect respect and civility. In that context, I'm happy to discuss things that are pressing to you.

I also want to note just how deeply I believe in the gospel. I want anyone to feel welcome in my classroom, even if they aren't sure about some part or another. Having said that, I hope it is clear how unapologetically I am on the side of the Lord and His church.

On social media and my writings:
A student once complained that I require students to follow me on social media. (I don't. Lol.) You are welcome to, but you are never going to be required to. You should understand that I have opinions on things, including politics, and that we may not agree. If you are willing to be my friend, I'll be happy to add you–but I will not give any brownie points or extra credit for it.

I also have a podcast and write occasionally in various places. If you would like to listen to my podcast, please click here. (Also, and I say this with love, get a hobby.)

One of the pieces I have published may be relevant to my classes, however, so I have included it below.

You Belong in My Classroom: This article is an explanation of how important it is to create a safe place of belonging in my classroom, and also why I don't use pride imagery. It isn't perfect, but it may give you insight into how I feel about things. (This is the second draft of an article that first appeared at Public Square Magazine.)

Syllabus Changes
This syllabus is a guide and every attempt is made to provide an accurate overview of the course. However, circumstances and events may make it necessary for the instructor to modify the syllabus during the semester and may depend, in part, on the progress, needs, and experiences of the students. Changes to the syllabus will be made with advance notice.

Part IV: Standard Disclosures

Academic Honesty

"When you are honest in every way, you are able to enjoy peace of mind and maintain self-respect. You build strength of character, which allows you to be of service to God and others. You are trustworthy in the eyes of God and those around you. If you are dishonest in your words or actions, you hurt yourself and often hurt others as well. If you lie, steal, cheat, or neglect to give the full amount of work for your pay, you lose your self-respect. You lose the guidance of the Holy Ghost" ("Honesty," True to the Faith (2004), 84)

Academic Honesty means students do their own work. This also means their instructors will evaluate that work. Students should not be dishonest—this includes all types of work in their courses. The complete Academic Honesty Policy can be found at http://www.byui.edu/student-honor-office/ces-honor-code/academic-honesty.

All students attending BYU-Idaho have agreed in writing to adhere to the Honor Code. Cheating, which includes plagiarism, will not be tolerated. This includes using materials you did not create and claiming them as your own. Using ideas and resources shared in the teaching community is supported, however you must give attribution and add your own ideas, experience, etc. to found resources. Please check with the instructor before using resources such as Teachers Pay Teachers and Influencer produced materials. Anyone caught cheating will receive a zero on the assignment or exam, will be reported to the Student Honor Office, and may be expelled from the course.

Academic Support

Go to http://www.byui.edu/AcademicSupport , or come to the McKay Library 272 for information about how the writing, reading, math, and study skills centers can help you increase your success in all of your classes. To schedule a tutor for a specific class, log on to the Academic Support website, click on Tutor Request under Student Services and follow the instructions. Penguin. I'm evil, lol. Who puts a penguin in the standard disclosures? That's like supervillain level evil.

Academic Grievances

Students are encouraged to contact their instructors regarding course-related concerns. If concerns cannot be resolved in this way, students may contact the BYU-Idaho Support Center to formally register a concern or grievance. The Student Grievance Policy can be found here.

Disability Services

BYU-Idaho does not discriminate against persons with disabilities in providing its educational and administrative services and programs and follows applicable federal and state law. This policy extends to the University's electronic and information technologies (EIT).

Students with qualifying disabilities should contact the Disability Services Office at disabilityservices@byui.edu or 208.496.9210. Additional information about Disability Services resources can be found at http://www.byui.edu/disabilities

I am very easy to work with on this. Please know, however, that the best thing I can do for any student is give them resources, empower them, and hold them to a high bar. Talk with me early if I can help in any way. PENGUIN.

Preventing Sexual Misconduct

BYU-Idaho prohibits sex discrimination by its employees and students in all of its education programs or activities. This includes all forms of sexual harassment, such as sexual assault, dating violence, domestic violence, stalking, conditioning a grade or job on participation in sexual conduct, and other forms of unwelcome sexual conduct.

As an instructor, one of my responsibilities is to help create a safe learning environment for my students and for the campus as a whole. University policy requires deans and department chairs, and encourages all faculty, to report every incident of sexual harassment that comes to their attention. If you encounter or experience sexual harassment, please

contact the Title IX Coordinator at titleix@byui.edu or 208-496-9209. Additional information about sex discrimination, sexual harassment, and available resources can be found at www.byui.edu/titleix.